One of the most important issues was the presentation of the armed forces case for the 6th Pay Commission. This happened when I was the chairman of the chiefs of staff committee and the army chief. The three services adopted a highly synergized strategy to get the best possible pay and perks package for all ranks. After preliminary deliberations, the broad principles to be followed by the pay commission cell were enunciated by me. These were:

- All three services pay cells should adopt a joint and unified approach. We should not work at cross purposes on any issue, but support each other's service-specific demands.
- The proposals should seek an equitable and just package to make the armed forces an attractive career. We must consciously pitch at a higher level, so that we get a substantial raise in the pay and allowances package.
- The 'X' factor should be quantified keeping in mind the unique and hazardous working environment. The service conditions and early retirement should be compensated adequately.
- 'One rank one pension' and disability or special pension should be strongly projected.

Certain key issues were spelt out by me for the army, and our pay commission cell was set up with effect from May 2006 under the supervision of Major General K.R. Rao, the additional director general (personnel and services). Under the guidance of General Rao, the pay cell did a magnificent job. After achieving unanimity amongst the three services, we made a forceful presentation to the 6th Pay Commission during March 2007. Thereafter, a memorandum was submitted to the Pay Commission containing the proposals of the armed forces on 15 April 2007. The commission announced its report in March 2008. All along we insisted that the award of this Pay Commission should be made effective from 1 January 2006. We were happy that the government finally agreed to do so. The major achievements of the armed forces on this issue were: